17 Tamuz 5785

Five פרוניות, five tragedies occurred on שבעה עשר בתמוז. They're all listed in משנה ברורה. The לוחות were broken, the קרבן תמיד was discontinued in the first בית המקדש, in the second בית המקדש the walls were breached, אפוסטמוס ימח שמו burned the ספר תורה - it was not just any ספר תורה, it was written by עזרא הסופר, and last, they put a געטשקע in the בית המקדש. A day of tragedies.

However, as tragic שבעה עשר בתמוז is, there's an amazing surprise revealed by the חתם סופר, as brought down by Rav Moshe Wolfson in his sefer (*Festivals of Faith*. Permission granted by ArtScroll / Mesorah Publications): שבעה עשר בתמוז was the day that Boaz married Rus. The spark of משיח that had been trapped in מואב was brought into life. As we know, משיח is going to come from that wedding.

What's interesting is that the שבת before שבעה עשר בתמוז is almost always פרשת בלק, which this year, תשפ"ה, is true. If Rus holds the spark of משיח, Balak was a קליפה holding in that spark. What was בלק's טענה to בלעם why he was afraid of כלל ישראל? His reason was כִּי רַב הוּא. Who are you kidding? We know we're the smallest of all the nations, we're tiny. What did he mean by כִּי רַב הוּא?

What is רַב? רַב stands for רות and בועז. Balak was scared that the spark of משיח would be released. What did he do? This is brilliant, the guy was brilliant. He said to בלעם, go and curse כלל ישראל. אָרָה לִי אֶת הָעָם - Curse that nation so that we will not be able to join them. Why? Because it says in the Torah לא יבוא עמוני ומואבי בקהל השם - Whoever curses כלל ישראל will be אסור לבוא בקהל. Balak said, "If we can't join כלל ישראל, Rus and Boaz can't get married. If they can't get married, משיח can't come. I want to keep that משיח spark here. I don't want to let it go. Therefore, let's curse the Jews and they will be forbidden to marry the people of מוֹאָב for all time, forever."

However, his idea backfired. The חכמים beat him at his own game. לא יבוא עמוני ומואבי, but מואבית, yes. As בלעם prophesied to בלק later, משיח would come from this nation. Rus was an elevated נשמה trapped in the טומאה of בלק.

What's fascinating is, וירא בלק בן צפר is the same gematria as חודש תמוז. Both are 771. Balak was a קליפה trapping Rus. תמוז is a lofty time, but it is currently trapped in טומאה. It's our job to release that spark. Just as Hashem freed Rus, Hashem will free תמוז, and שבעה עשר בתמוז will once again become the holiday it was supposed to be when משה brought down the לוחות. Have a meaningful and easy fast.

https://youtu.be/OQg7HK84jI0